O-D-1407
August 9, 1972
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-22287A(Wep)
23 November 1962

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DRY CHEMICAL, FIRE EXTINGUISHING, POTASSIUM BICARBONATE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Semite, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies .

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of dry chemical powder composed largely of pure potassium bicarbonate suitable for fire extinguishers used in conjunction with mechanical foam (see 6.3).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
O-F-555	-	Foam-Forming Liquids, Concentrated, Fire Extinguishing, Mechanical.
RR-S-366	-	Sieves, Standard For Testing Purposes.
PPP-D-705	-	Drum, Metal Shipping, Steel (Over 12 and Under 55 Gallons).
PPP-D-729	-	Drums, Metal, 55 Gallons (For Shipment of Noncorrosive Material).
PPP-P-704	-	Pails, Shipping Steel (1 Through 12 Gallons).

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, and Standards, at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

FSC 4210

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D,C., Atlanta Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks, and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards, from established distribution points in their agencies,)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads for Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads 40″ X 48″ Pallets Skids, Runners, or Pallet-Type Base.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)

D-5 - Method Test for Penetration of Bituminous Materials.

(Application for copies of publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103.)

Container Corporation of America

Color Harmony Manual

(Application for copies of the Color Harmony Manual should be addressed to Container Corporation of America, Department of Color Standards, 38 S. Dearborn Street, Chicago 60603.)

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Munsell Color Company

Munsell Book of Color.

(Application for copies of the Munsell Book of Color should be addressed to Munsell Color Company, 10 East Franklin Street, Baltimore, Maryland 21202.) "

National Fire Protection Association

NFPA Pamphlet No. 11 - "Standards for Foam Extinguishing Systems"S

(Application for copies of Pamphlet No. 11, "Standards for Foam Extinguishing Systems," should be addressed to National Fire Protection Association, 60 Batterymarch Street, Boston, Mass. 02110.)

Precision Scientific Company

Bulletin No. 4360 PSCO-4-52 - "Precision" Blaine Air Permeability Fineness Tester.

(Application for copies of bulletin No. 4360 PSCO-4-52 should be addressed to Precision Scientific Company, 3737 W. Cartland Street, Chicago, Ill. 60647.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 S. Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Chemical and physical requirements. The dry chemical powder shall conform to the requirements of table I. Materials may be added to improve the fluidity, foam compatibility, appearance, and noncaking characteristics of the finished powder. These additives shall not be sodium compounds of any type and shall not give off toxic vapors when subjected to intense heat.

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3.1.1 Particle size. The particle size distribution of the dry chemical powder, tested in accordance with 4.3.11, shall be within the limits specified in table II.

TABLE I. Chemical and physical requirements

Requirement	Value	Test Paragraph
Potassium bicarbonate ($KHC0_3$) content, percent by weight, minimum	92.0	4.3.1
Moisture content, percent by weight, maximum	0.2	4.3.2
Hygroscopicity, percent gain in weight, maximum	3.0	4.3.3
Apparent density, grams per milliliter, minimum	0.88	4.3.4
Caking and lumping tendency, minimum penetration	15 mm. or. 150 units	4.3.5
Packed density, grams per milliliter, minimum	1012	4.3.6
Packed powder discharge, percent by weight, minimum	88.0	4.3.7
Foam compatibility, average drainage rate, ml./minute, maximum	2.5	4.3.8
Specific surface area, square centimeters per gram	4200-5200	4.3.9
Color identification	purple	4.3.10

TABLE 11. Particle size

U. S. screen size	Percent retained Minimum	Maximum
40		0.0
100		2.5
200		8.0
325	12.0	20.0
Bottom pan	74.0	88.0

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the examination of filled containers (4.2.2) and lot acceptance tests (4.2.3).

4.2.1 Sampling.

4.2.1.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of five batches or less when this fulfills the requirements of an order. When more than five batches are required to fill an order, the batches shall be grouped as equally as possible by weight to give not less than three nor more than five lots.

4.2.1.2 Lot acceptance test samples. Samples from a lot comprised of five batches or less shall consist of a two (2) pound composite batch sample and shall immediately be placed in a clean, dry, air and watertight container which shall be sealed, marked, and sent to a testing laboratory satisfactory to the procuring agency concerned. The sample shall be subjected to all the tests, as specified in 4.3. When more than five batches are required to fulfill an order, the batches shall be grouped as equally as possible by weight to give not less than three nor more than five lots. A sufficient quantity shall be taken from each batch to make a ten-pound composite lot sample when the lot consists of more than five batches. Each lot composite sample shall be prepared for testing as above,

4.2.2 Examination of filled containers. A random sample of filled containers shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level I, and acceptable quality level (AQL) equal to 2.5 percent defective to verify compliance with all stipulations of this specification regarding fill, closure, packaging, packing, marking, and other requirements not involving tests. Containers shall be examined for defects of the container and the closure, for evidence of leakage, and for unsatisfactory markings; each sample filled container shall also be weighed to determine the amount of the contents. Any container in the sample having one or more defects or under required fill shall be rejected, and if the number of defective containers in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for the appropriate sampling plan of MIL-STD-105, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.2.3 Lot acceptance tests. Lot acceptance test samples selected in accordance with 4.2.1.2 shall be tested for conformance with all the section 3 requirements. If the acceptance test sample fails to pass one or more of these tests, the lot represented shall be rejected.

4.3 Test methods. Each test shall be run in triplicate and the results averaged.

4.3.1 Composition. Standard, officially recognized, analytical procedures, either of the direct or subtractive type, for the analysis of potassium bicarbonate may be used and the results reported in terms of $KHC0_3$, percentage by weight.

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4.3.2 Moisture content. In an atmosphere of 50 percent relative humidity or less, weigh accurately a sample of approximately 50 grams (± 1 mg.) in a tared aluminum dish approximately 68 mm. diameter by 18 mm. Place the dish in a desiccator using H_2S0_4, A.C.S. reagent grade, 95 percent to 98 percent by weight, as a drying agent. Maintain the closed desiccator and contents at a temperature of 70° F. (± 5°) for 24 hours. At the end of this period remove the test samples and weigh accurately. The moisture content of the sample is calculated as follows:

$$M = \frac{100\ (W_1 - W_2)}{W_1}$$

Where: M= moisture content, percent
W_1= original weight of sample
W_2= weight of sample after 24 hours drying

4.3.3 Hygroscopicity. Using an aluminum moisture dish of approximately 68 mm. diameter by 18 mm. height as a sample container, overfill with the material and then strike off with a straight edge. Cap the dish with its cover and weigh accurately. Remove the cover and place the sample in a humidifier with circulating air (as described in 4.3.5) maintained at 78 percent R.H. and 70° ± 5° F. for a period of 48 hours. At the end of this period, cover the sample and weigh it. Determine the gain in weight and calculate the percentage gain in weight of the sample.

4.3.4 Apparent density. Place 100 grams (± 0.1 gram) of sample in a clean, dry 250 ml. glass-stoppered graduated cylinder, having an I.D. of approximately 3.5 cm. Stopper the cylinder and rotate slowly end over end for 10 complete cycles. After this agitation, set the cylinder upright on a surface and allow to settle for 60 seconds. Read the volume occupied by the sample and report as apparent density as follows:

$$\text{Apparent density (grams per ml.)} = \frac{100 \text{ grams}}{\text{Volume of sample, ml.}}$$

4.3.5 Caking and lumping tendency test. In order to determine the inherent tendencies of dry chemical toward caking and lumping, each sample shall be alternately placed in a moving air stream humidifier at 78 percent R.H. and a drying oven at 118° F. To start the test, two 125 gram samples shall be placed in nickel crucible-shaped cups (100 ml. capacity, 60 mm. diameter at top, 64 mm. height), then vibrated for five minutes on a Tyler Ro-Tap or equal sieve shaker using a suitable holder. The samples shall then be placed in the moving air stream humidifier for a period of 24 hours after which time they shall be placed in the drying oven for a period of 24 hours. At the conclusion of the second period (total 48 hours) the degree of caking is determined with a Precision Universal Penetrometer meeting the requirements of ASTM Std. D5. Penetration is defined as the resistance of the material, expressed as the distance that a standard needle penetrates vertically into the sample under known conditions of

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load and time. The moving weight of the needle used is 50 grams and the time 5 seconds. An average of six readings (three from each sample) shall be used.

Note: Stagnant air conditions found in the usual saturated solution desiccator compartments are not conducive to consistent results and precautions must be taken to insure air circulation if a desiccator is used as the humidifier. A 250 mm. diameter desiccator with a saturated NH_4C1 solution in the lower compartment may be used in this determination. During operation a circulating air supply of five liters per minute shall be presaturated by bubbling through a saturated NH_4Cl solution and then introduced into the desiccator through a center tube with 6 mm. I.D. terminating 2 cm. above the center hold in the desiccator plate. It is advisable to check the relative humidity of the exit air stream from time to time by some convenient means.

4.3.6 Packed density. The packed density of the dry chemical shall be obtained by determining its weight per volume after a period of extreme packing produced by vibration. Equipment necessary for conducting the packed density analysis includes a conveniently shortened 250 ml. graduated glass cylinder (approximately 1-11/32 I.D.) fitted with a No. 8 rubber stopper, and a Tyler Ro-Tap or equal sieve shaking machine. A 100 gram sample of dry chemical is poured into the graduate which is placed in a convenient holder modified to fit into the shaking machine. The graduate is shaken on the machine for 30 minutes . After the shaking period the volume of the powder is read directly in milliliters from the graduated cylinder. An average of three runs on one sample is used in making the packed density calculation, as follows:

$$\text{Packed density (grams per milliliter)} = \frac{\text{Wt. of sample (grams)}}{\text{Packed volume of sample (ml.)}}$$

4.3.7 Packed powder percent discharge. A 30-pound cartridge-operated, external gas bottle type, dry chemical fire extinguisher shall be utilized as the standard apparatus for determination of percent discharge.

4.3.7.1 Procedure. Thirty pounds of dry chemical shall be introduced into the tared fire extinguisher. The charged extinguisher shall then be vibrated at a frequency of 20 cycles per second and at an excursion of 0.050 inch for a period of 10 minutes. The extinguisher shall then be placed in an oven for 24 hours at 130° ± 5° F. Upon completion of the oven cycle, the extinguisher shall be pressurized with the proper $C0_2$ cartridge. After maximum pressure has been achieved, the extinguisher shall be discharged until the pressure is dissipated. The extinguisher shall then be reweighed and the packed powder percentage discharge calculated on the basis of the original charged weight as follows:

$$\text{Packed powder percentage discharge} = \frac{100\ (A-B)}{W}$$

A = weight in pounds of extinguisher and packed powder before discharge.
B = weight in pounds of extinguisher and packed powder after discharge.
W = weight in pounds of packed powder charge.

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4.3.8 Foam compatibility test. Weigh out a 10 gram (± 0.1 gram) portion of the sample dry chemical powder and place in a suitable closed container until ready for use. The protein type foam-forming concentrate to be tested in conjunction with the dry chemical powder shall conform to O-F-555.

Prepare a sample of foam from 200 ml. of a 6 percent aqueous solution of foam concentrate at 70° F. Pour into the large bowl of a kitchen mixer (Sunbeam Mixmaster, Model 12C type or equal) and beat it at a speed of 870 r.p.m. for 3.0 minutes (± 3 seconds).

Remove the foam with the aid of a kitchen spatula or rubber batter scraper carefully filling a standard foam container (see NFPA Pamphlet No. 11, Foam Standards). When check-tested by the methods shown in Pamphlet No. 11, the expansion of the foam sample should be no less than 10 or no greater than 11.5 and the drainage time no less than 25 minutes .

Level out the surface of the foam in the pan and then dust the previously weighed sample of dry chemical over the surface of the foam by sifting it through a 2-1/4 inch diameter 80 mesh screen. Move the screen uniformly over the foam surface while gently tapping the sides.

After this dusting operation and at 3 minutes (± 3 seconds) from the end of the beating period place the pan on the sloping front stand so that the foam is exposed to a heat source. As the pan is inserted at 70° F. ± 10°, a sheet of 1/2 inch thick transite (8 in. x 8 in.) shall be placed beneath the pan to insulate it from the hot stand. The heat source consisting of a 1000 watt electrical hot plate with a 7-inch diameter face (Edwin L. Wiegand Co., Pittsburgh, Pa., Model ROPH-100 or equal), shall be mounted upside down over a 6-1/2 inch diameter hole in a 1/2 inch thick piece of transite. The temperature of the hot plate face shall be maintained at 1000° F. by varying the current input using a Variac transformer. (In order to determine this temperature, it is convenient to use a thermocouple embedded in the hot plate.)

The drainage pan shall be placed in a stand having a slope toward the front of l-inch in 12-inches and so constructed that the top of the pan and the foam surface is 2-3/8 inches below the radiating hot plate surface.

Place a 100 ml. graduate under the draw-off tube of the foam container and draw off the liquid draining from the foam at 1/2 minute intervals. Record the cumulative volume as long as liquid run-off continues and plot these values on linear coordinate paper with elapsed time as the ordinate and total drained volume as the abscissa.

To calculate the average drainage rate of liquid from the foam, work with the straight line portion of the curve only. Take the total volume of liquid recovered during the period covered by the straight line and divide this by the time in minutes over which this total volume was collected. This represents the average drainage rate in ml./min.

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In order to obtain a blank or control analysis, repeat the entire foam generation and heat exposure cycle given above but omit the operation of sifting the powder on the surface of the foam. Calculate the average drainage rate of the foam blank as done previously. The results are reported as an average of three complete tests, including the blank analysis.

4.3.9 Specific surface area test procedure. The Blaine Air Permeability Method has been selected as the standard test procedure for determination of specific surface area, This apparatus and instructions for its use are commercially available from the Precision Scientific Co., Chicago, Ill. The test procedure is similar to the ASTM C-204 test used for cement samples.

A slight modification has been made in the Blaine apparatus; this consists of doubling the depth of the bed in order to increase the time interval for better reproducibility of results. It will be necessary to machine down the bakelite plunger to give an effective bed depth of 2.93 centimeters instead of the original 1.47 centimeters. Also, to insure duplicate filling of the cell it is necessary to make successive additions of 1 gram each, lightly tapping or vibrating after each addition. The cell shall be filled so that the plunger can be depressed to the collar when a pressure of 10 pounds is applied for a period of 3 minutes.

The density of the powder should be determined by using a 50 ml. pycnometer with n-heptane as the liquid, Carman's equation relating specific surface to permeability should be used for all calculations. This equation is included in the pamphlet that accompanies the apparatus ,

4.3.10 Color identification. The powder sample, viewed in bulk in its container, shall be compared in hue and chroma to Munsell 5.OP8/2 or to the Color Harmony Manual Chip 12. ca. and shall be reported as passing or failing.

4.3.11 Particle size. The shaker used in conducting particle size tests shall operate with a single eccentric circular motion at 285 (± 10) revolutions per minute and with a tapping action of 150 strokes per minute to obtain dependable sieve analyses. To permit flexible operations, the shaker shall accommodate one to six 8-inch diameter sieves with one pan and cover. Screen sizes used for particle size analysis shall conform to U, S. Standard Screen Sizes as outlined in RR-S-366 and shall be stainless steel, and non-supported.

In an atmosphere of 50 percent R.H. or less, place an accurately weighed sample of approximately 50 grams in the top screen of a nested series of 8-inch U. S. Standard screens consisting of a 40-mesh, 100-mesh, 200-mesh, 325-mesh, with cover and bottom pan. Agitate the screen nest for 5 minutes on a shaker employing eccentric circular motion and tapping action such as with the Tyler Ro-Tap machine. Separate the screen nest and weigh accurately the amount remaining on each screen, expressing the results in percentage of the original sample. NOTE : Care must be taken to remove all the residue from the screen. Sieves should be cleaned with a camel hair brush to insure complete removal of the fine particles.

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4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The marking and preparation for delivery requirements of the dry chemical shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of section 5 of this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The material shall be furnished in the following type containers.

5.1.1.1 Pails. Unless otherwise specified, the material shall be packed in a single bead, 6-gallon pail with wire ball, handle, and grip conforming to PPP-P-704, type II, class 2, except that a 26-gage cover with a lever-lock, reusable type ring shall be used in lieu of the lug cover. The lever-lock ring and cover shall be fitted with a suitable type rubber sealing gasket. The containers shall be provided with a polyethylene liner conforming to L-P-378. The thickness of the polyethylene film shall be not less than 0.0040 inches . The open end of the liner shall be sealed in a manner that will prevent entry of moisture.

5.1.1.2 Drums. Containers larger than 6-gallon capacity shall conform to PPP-D-705 or PPP-D-729, as applicable. The drum shall be provided with a full removable head and a polyethylene liner conforming to L-P-378. The thickness of the polyethylene film shall be not less than 0.0040 inch. The open end of the liner shall be sealed in a manner that will prevent entry of moisture.

5.1.2 Level C. The material shall be packed in a manner which will insure arrival a-nation in satisfactory condition and be acceptable to the carrier at lowest rates . Containers and packing shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.2 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), filled containers shall be palletized in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-STD-147.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The material covered by this specification is intended for fires involving flammable liquids or greases. It is not intended for use on deep-seated fires of ordinary combustible materials such as wood, paper, textiles, etc.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Level of packing required (see 5.1).

(c) When palletization is required (see 5.2).

(d) Special markings, if required (see 5.3).

6.3 Shipboard use. This product has not been approved for shipboard use. Potential users are advised that use aboard ship may result in agglomeration of the powder causing malfunctioning of the fire extinguisher. Information regarding shipboard use may be obtained from Commander, Naval Ships Engineering Center, Center Building, Prince George's Center, Hyattsville, Maryland 20782.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - ME
Navy - YD
Air Force - 84

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Navy - YD

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

Review activities:

Army - CE
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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
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INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION

O-D-1407: Dry Chemical, Fire Extinguishing, Potassium Bicarbonate

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE	CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*	DATE

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